Store & Inventory: the full workflow

From setup to month-end: every step, who does it, and what the software does at each one. Purchase, stores, production, sales, labels, reports and closing - the inventory module only.

1. The big picture

Goods come in through purchase, are held in stores, are used by departments and production, and leave through sales. Every movement is written to the **stock ledger**, which every report, alert and the month-end close read.

Purchase	**Purchase requisition**	>	**Purchase order**	>	**Goods receipt (GRN)**	>	**Quality check**
Stores	**Store requisition**	>	**Store issue**	>	**Material return**	>	**Transfer / count**
Production	**BOM (recipe)**	>	**Production order**	>	**Material use**	>	**Output: new FG batch**
Sales	**Sales order / AI / API**	>	**Confirm (reserve)**	>	**Delivery challan**	>	**Invoice > paid**
Control	**Stock ledger**	>	**Reports and dashboard**	>	**Morning alert**	>	**Month-end close**

Stores: raw material, packaging, spares, general, finished goods, production floor - plus **quarantine** (waiting for QC), **rejected** (damaged or failed) and **transit** (between stores). Stock in quarantine, rejected and transit stores can never be issued, used or sold.

2. One-time setup

Done once before go-live (Inventory › Go-live checks every item).

#	Step	Who	Where	What it decides
1	Switch the module on	Platform owner	Companies › Feature access	Store & Inventory for the company
2	Inventory settings	Owner / admin	Inventory › Inventory settings	Average cost for the company or per store (fixed once stock moves); label sizes; expiry warning days; slow-moving days; who gets the morning alert
3	Units, categories, items	Store manager	Inventory › Items (or Import)	Code, English and Bangla name, type, base unit and packs, batch / expiry / shelf life, QC, reorder point, cost, sale price, VAT, usual store
4	Stores and bins	Store manager	Inventory › Stores, Bins	Each store belongs to a branch; bins say exactly where
5	Suppliers, customers, price lists	Purchase, sales	Inventory › Suppliers / Customers; Sales › Price lists	Payment terms, credit limits, the customer's price list
6	People and permissions	Owner	Organisation › Access	Who issues, approves, buys, receives, checks, produces, sells, closes. Every approval needs a second person
7	Opening stock	Store manager + approver	Inventory › Go-live › Count sheets; Opening stock	Count every store, import the count, post it (someone else), print all labels

3. Purchase

Buying from suppliers, from the first request to stock on the shelf.

Step	Who	What happens
Purchase requisition	Requester (purchase.request)	Asks for goods to be bought > sent for approval
Approve requisition	Approver (purchase.approve), not their own	Its lines can now be ordered
Purchase order	Buyer (purchase.order)	Supplier, quantities, price, discount, VAT > submit. Can be made straight from approved requisitions
Approve order	Approver	Approve, or send back with a note > then PDF or email to the supplier
Goods receipt (GRN)	Receiver (purchase.receive)	Against the order (its open lines fill in) or without one: received and rejected quantity, supplier batch, expiry - or scan the supplier's GS1 barcode > **Post**: stock is in, at its cost; batches are made
Labels	Receiver	One label per package, printed from the receipt and stuck on before putting away
Quality check	QC (purchase.qc)	Items that need QC wait in quarantine. **Passed**: usable. **Failed**: batch blocked
Purchase return	Receiver	Failed or damaged goods back to the supplier, at the cost they came in at
Close / cancel	Buyer	Cancel before anything arrives; close a partly received order with the reason

4. Store operations

Day-to-day work in the stores.

Step	Who	What happens
Store requisition	Department (inventory.issue)	A department asks a store for materials > send for approval
Approve requisition	Department head (inventory.issue_approve), not their own	The store may now issue it
Store issue	Store keeper (inventory.issue)	From the requisition (lines fill in) or on its own; batches taken **first expiry first**; or scan the cartons > **Post**: stock out at its average cost
Material return	Store keeper	Unused goods back from a department or production: good to the store, damaged to the Rejected store, at the issue's cost
Transfer	Store keeper (inventory.transfer)	**Dispatch**: in transit, not usable on the way > the other store **Receives**; anything missing is written off with its reason
Stock adjustment	Adjuster (inventory.adjust) + approver	Stock written off or found, with a reason (damaged, expired, found…) > approved by someone else = posted
Stock count	Adjuster + approver	Start (quantities frozen) > enter counts or scan labels > submit > approve: every difference becomes a posted adjustment
Reverse	The same roles	A posted document is never edited: Reverse it (with a reason) and enter it again

5. Production

Turning materials into finished goods.

Step	Who	What happens
BOM (recipe)	production.bom	What one batch needs: materials and packaging with scrap % > **Activate**. A change is a new version; running orders keep theirs
Production order	Planner (production.plan)	Product, quantity, date, material store, output store
Release	Planner, not who planned it	Materials can now be used
Use materials	Operator (production.execute)	The BOM's quantities fill in, first expiry first, or scan the bags > post: out of the material store
Return materials	Operator	Unused material back to the store
Record output	Operator	Good and rejected quantity, once > a new finished-goods batch at **materials used ÷ good quantity**; labels for the cartons
QC and close	QC, planner	QC-required products wait in quarantine until passed; then close the order

The order page shows planned against used for every material; the Production yield report shows yield %, rejects and cost per run.

6. Sales

From the customer's order to payment. Raw materials can be sold too, from their own store.

Step	Who	What happens
Sales order	Sales (sales.order)	Customer, lines at the customer's price list (or the item's sale price); each line from its own store - juice from finished goods and sugar from raw materials on one order
Orders from outside	AI order inbox; API	Emails and pasted WhatsApp text are read by the AI into draft orders a person reviews; other systems send orders by code through the API. Nothing is confirmed automatically
Confirm	sales.approve, not who entered it	**Reserves** the stock first expiry first; over the credit limit it asks why. Reserved stock cannot be issued or used by anyone else
Deliver	sales.deliver	One delivery challan per store, from the reservation > check or scan cartons > **Post**: goods out, reservation released; challan PDF
Invoice	sales.invoice	Exactly what was delivered at the order's prices, discount and VAT > issue (due date from payment terms) > **mark paid** (date, reference)
Sales return	sales.deliver	Goods back at the cost they went out at: good to the store, damaged to Rejected
Close / cancel	sales.order	Cancel frees the reservation; close a partly delivered order

7. Labels and scanning

Label	Printed from	Used for
Item label	The item's page	Shelves; items without batches
Batch label	Opening stock, the item's batch	One card per batch: item, batch, expiry
Package label	GRN, production output, an item's Package labels	Each carton or bag with its quantity: scan it into issues, transfers, counts, deliveries
Bin label	Stores / Bins	Where things are
Scan box	Inventory › Scan, and every document	One scan says what a label, barcode or GS1 code is - with warnings (expired, quarantined, used up)

A label printed before is a reprint: the reason is asked and kept.

8. What the software stops

Rules that hold on every screen and in the API.

Refused	Why
Taking more than is there	A store, bin or batch never goes below zero
Using an expired, quarantined or blocked batch	Issues, production and deliveries need usable stock
Taking stock reserved for a sales order	Only that order's delivery may take it
A batch that is not the first to expire	Allowed, but you must say why
Approving your own document	Every approval is someone else's (owner and administrator excepted)
Posting into a closed month	Corrections go in the open month
Editing a posted document	Reverse it with a reason, then enter it again

9. Reports, dashboard and alerts

Inventory › Dashboard and Inventory › Reports; every report downloads as Excel or PDF.

Report	Shows
Dashboard	Stock value by type and store, low stock, expiring, quarantine, work waiting, today's production and sales
Stock on hand / Stock ledger (item card)	What is where now; one item's every move with running balance
Movement summary / Stock valuation	Opening, in, out, closing; quantity and value at the close of **any past date**, straight from the ledger
Batch and expiry / Stock aging / Slow-moving	Expired and expiring first; age brackets; items not used for N days
Reorder report	At or below the reorder point: available, on order, suggested quantity
Consumption by department	What each department took, less returns
Purchase register / GRN register	Orders placed; goods received with batches and QC
Production yield and wastage	Planned against good and rejected, cost per run
Sales register / Customer and item sales	Invoices, VAT, unpaid; quantity, amount and margin per customer and item
Morning stock alert (email)	Every morning: what to reorder, what is expired or expiring
AI daily and weekly report (email)	Orders, deliveries, invoicing, low stock, production - with a short summary paragraph

10. Month-end close

Inventory › Month-end close, by the 5th of the next month (inventory.period_close).

Step	What happens
Check	The page lists documents dated in the month that are not posted, and the stock check
Fix	Post, cancel or re-date waiting documents; the ledger and balances must agree
Close	Nothing more is posted dated in that month
Valuation	Download the stock valuation at the month's last day for the books
Reopen (rare)	With a reason, recorded - figures already reported may change

11. Who does what

Permissions are given per person and branch on the Access page.

Role	Permissions
Store keeper	View stock; store requisitions, issues and returns; transfers; print labels
Department head	Approve store requisitions
Purchase	Raise requisitions; make purchase orders; a different person approves
Receiving and QC	Receive goods (GRN) and purchase returns; quality check
Production	Set up BOMs; plan and release; use materials and record output
Sales	Enter sales orders and price lists; a different person confirms; deliver; invoice and record payments
Managers and accounts	See stock costs and values; approve adjustments and opening stock; close a stock month

12. Going live

The full runbook is docs/inventory/11-GO-LIVE.md; Inventory › Go-live shows what is still missing.

When	What
3 weeks before	Decisions signed; server updated; module on; settings saved
2 weeks before	Masters imported; price lists; permissions given
1 week before	Label printer and scanners tested; training role by role
Count day	Count sheets per store > count > import as opening stock > post > print and stick labels
2 weeks	Parallel run with the old method; weekly comparison (Go-live › Compare) until two clean weeks
Switch	The old method stops; close the first month together